

doesn't mean we are abandoning Android. It is about the company's belief that this is the platform that will help us integrate devices seamlessly.

Q But don't you think it will take some time to build awareness around Tizen? On the other hand, Android is already established in India. Also, Samsung reportedly has not done very well in the wearables segment, as you had to cut prices of Galaxy Gear at a very early stage.

To answer the later part of your question, Samsung Galaxy Gear did very well in the market—totally as per our expectations. We feel that there are various inflection points at which we can increase the demand. And that's what we have done for Galaxy Gear. We increased the demand tremendously by bringing the prices of the device down. Coming back to the first part of your question, we feel it's not about Android or Tizen. It is about giving customers a good experience. If you are able to offer a great customer experience, irrespective of the platform, that is when you have hit the right chord. That is what our focus is. We feel we can work much faster because Samsung is not just in the mobile phones business, but also in other domains. We are trying to build an entire ecosystem where mobile devices can talk to your refrigerators, your television sets, and so on. That is why we have chosen Tizen as the platform.

Q So how are wearables faring in India?

It is a new category. We have to build awareness. We have to invest in creating demand for wearable devices. We have to bring in products at a price point that is affordable for people. Gear Fit is a great device at Rs 15,900. Second, while there have been launches of wearables by Samsung and other brands, we do see a lot of people bringing these from outside India and wearing them. That is a big market, which we clearly see.

"Samsung is looking at the broader ecosystem that will help devices interact with each other, as it also has a whole range of consumer electronics devices. Tizen can work with your refrigerator or TV set. That is one major reason why it was brought in."

Wearables are not just about technology, they are more about a lifestyle. As we see more and more people getting into fitness, we see wearables becoming a rage.

Q How do you plan to involve developers with the Tizen platform?

We have released the SDK and we are inviting developers from across the globe to build applications. We have made it very easy for them to get access to the code. We also have a very strong unit that works with the developers to build applications on our platforms. We already have a whole bunch of applications for Gear 2 devices. And the number is only going to increase further.

Q Don't you think developers will not be so keen on developing apps for wearables compared to developing for smartphones and tablets, purely because of the kind of reach that they get in the latter segment?

Since this is a new category, of course there will be some developers who would want to wait and watch. But as the category evolves, there will be more and more interest from developers. And there will be a lot of them who will want to be the first to get on the wearables bandwagon and build applications for these devices. **END**

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